So, this was the ghastly, shocking tale of the Taj Mahal which send shivers down my spine. In childhood, a visit to Delhi's vicinity was all about posing for a picture in front of the Taj. I was heartbroken when the insights came in. It was devastating to realize how a lot of facts had been brushed under the carpet, which would end up making Taj, the pride of Indian 'pain'.

A lot needs to be written about this subject and certainly, this is not something which would get over even in a million words. This book is the first in the long series on the Tīmūrids, whom we know as Moghūls, that I wish to write. While taking up this project, I decided to be as honest as possible concerning the primary sources and present the utmost facts that had been recorded in the contemporary period.

When I began writing about Babur, the book ended up with around two lakh words. This would have made the book around one-and-half-times bulkier than how it stands today. Discussing with experts I came up with three ways:

I. Have the first volume published with the same length.
II. Shorten the narration by reducing the details.
III. Pass on a few parts of Babur's life into the next volume along with Humayu

After giving it much thought, I decided to go with the third way. But doing so, I invited a risk, too. I was of the opinion that the nation is badly polarized today and everyone has choices when it comes to reading history. Babur's life has so many layers and I thought that dividing his life story may lead to a polarized reading of events. It was important to sort out this dilemma and I discussed the concern with people of diverse opinions. It appeared that I was misjudging the readers. The risk that I was envisioning was hypothetical and readers are more concerned about knowing complete details of the matter.

Hence, I decided to limit Babur's tale in this volume to his second failed attempt to enter Hindustan. In the volumes to follow, a lot about the Hindustan's resistance will be spoken of. It would also cover more about the economic policies that the Tīmūrids had for the Hindustanis.

One more concern that hit me in the middle of writing this book was why should people prefer my work (say volume 1) when today the translated version of the *Baburnama* is readily available for everyone to read.

The short answer lies in a fact—that until any historical instance is read with context and related past, the matter can't grant us a complete analysis of a particular time. As far as the *-namas* of the Tīmūrid emperors are concerned, they can give us the sequence of events, but contextual elaborations (in the form of footnotes, further readings, appendices, citing other sources during narrative)